Open scholarship Vs AI

Thoughts from the front line of scholarly resources

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Contact us:

the problems

- AI is here and is affecting the scholarly landscape.
- Our readers use AI but are also troubled by it
- Researchers worry their OA work in our repositories is being harvested by LLMs
- There are both actual and perceived risks
- How do we address the tension between open research and commercial use at a research library?

risks

- Doing nothing isn't an option
- Staff concerns re ethical & environmental impact of AI
- We have to comply with many OA regulations
- Our websites are grinding to a halt
- Researchers are increasingly concerned about AI harvesting - we need to act before they disengage with OA

technology

- Web scraping is bringing our websites to a crawl
- Companies & scrapers are ignoring robots.txt
- How do we limit bots without losing human users?

opportunities

- Libraries are experts in information creation, management and discovery
- There is interest in digitisation of our collections
- AI is a live conversation & we can be a part of it
- Educating researchers about AI & OA
- Opportunities for national or sectorial training sets & data infrastructures

policies

- The UK government is consulting and reforming laws which affect generative AI, LLMs and the data rights within
- It is also mandating stronger OA policies for research outputs
- As a libraries sector we have an opportunity to engage with tech companies, publishers & government & advocate for our role as information experts

our approach

Advocacy & partnerships

- Tech companies (OpenAI)
- Publishers
- Government
- Legal deposit
- International GLAM sector

Articulate the value of research libraries

We have:

- a 'diamond mine' of latent data
- Gained our data legitimately & fairly (mostly)
- lots of metadata
- information provenance
- information expertise

Help us understand the wider issues - complete our survey